

25STCV11261 25STCV11261

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 309

Hearing date: 2026-08-03

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Case Number: 25STCV11261 Hearing Date: August 3, 2026 Dept: 309

Superior Court of California

County of Los Angeles

DEPARTMENT 309

TENTATIVE

RULING

PEDRO ORANTES, et al.

vs.

JORGE SERENO, et al.

Case No.: 25STCV11261

Hearing Date: August 4, 2026

Defendant Jorge Sereno's motion to compel Plaintiff Abera Kassa to serve verified, code-compliant responses, without objections, to Defendant's Form Interrogatories, General (Set One) is DENIED.

The request for sanctions is incomplete and not addressed in any declaration. Court declines to award sanctions at this time.

On 4/17/2025, Plaintiffs Pedro

Orantes and Abera Kassa (collectively, Plaintiffs) filed suit against Defendant Jorge Sereno, alleging: (1) motor vehicle negligence; (2) general negligence. On 9/17/2025, Plaintiff amended the Complaint to add Defendant A.N. TOW, Inc.

On 5/5/2026, Defendant Jorge Sereno (Defendant) moved to compel Plaintiff Abera Kassa (Kassa) to serve verified, code-compliant responses, without objections, to Defendant's Form Interrogatories, General (Set One). Defendant seeks monetary sanctions in connection with the motion.

Discussion

On 2/23/2026, Defendant served Kassa with Form Interrogatories (Set One). To date, no responses have been provided.

In opposition, pro per Kassa indicates that supplemental responses have since been provided, and attached the supplemental responses in support.

Given that initial responses have been provided, the substance of the motion is moot. Moreover, given Kassa's good faith provision of responses prior to the hearing, the Court declines to award sanctions at this time. However, the Court notes that Plaintiff's pro per status does not excuse him from mandated response deadlines, and Plaintiff will be sanctioned moving forward for failure without substantial justification to abide by rules mandated by the California Code of Civil Procedure and the California Rules of Court.

Based on the foregoing, Defendant Jorge Sereno's motion to compel Plaintiff Abera Kassa to serve verified, code-compliant responses, without objections, to Defendant's Form Interrogatories, General (Set One) is denied. The Court declines to award sanctions at this time.

It is so ordered.

Dated:
August , 2026

Hon. Jon R. Takasugi

Judge of the
Superior Court

Parties who intend to submit on this tentative must send an email to the court at by 4 p.m. the day prior as directed by the instructions provided on the court website at www.lacourt.org. If a party submits on the tentative, the party's email must include the case number and must identify the party submitting on the tentative.

If all parties to a motion submit, the court will adopt this tentative as the final order. If the department does not receive an email indicating the parties are submitting on the tentative and there are no appearances at the hearing, the motion may be placed off calendar. For more information, please contact the court clerk at (213) 633-0517.